

PROBLEM INTERVIEWS TRANSCRIPTS

Project: AgTech - Pesticide Application Records & Compliance Software **Date Generated:** April 09, 2026

Overview

This document contains interview transcripts conducted to validate the problem space for AgTech - Pesticide Application Records & Compliance Software.

Interview 1 of 5 - Marina (AI Persona)

Demographics: Licensed pesticide applicator, small operation owner, SE Missouri region

Backstory: Marina recently switched from manual paper-based record-keeping and a basic weather app to SprayMapper after a compliance inspection two months ago. She experienced significant anxiety around regulatory adherence and is actively seeking a more robust compliance-focused solution.

Communication Style: The Elaborator

Transcript

Interviewer: On a scale of 1 to 10, how concerned are you about compliance right now — and what would it take to make that concern go away?

Marina: I'd say I'm at a 7 right now. I'm not panicked, but it's definitely on my mind regularly. Before that inspection, I was probably at an 8 or 9—I was really anxious. Now that I've switched to SprayMapper and I'm being more intentional about documentation, I've brought it down a bit. But there's still room for improvement.

What would make that concern go away? Honestly, I need a system that I can trust completely. Something that does the compliance checking for me—not just logs the data, but actually verifies that what I'm doing meets EPA requirements in real time. If I could log an application and the system tells me, "Yes, you're good. These conditions meet all the RUP requirements," that would give me real peace of mind.

Right now, even with SprayMapper, I'm still doing manual verification. I'm still worried I might miss

something. If there was a tool that integrated the EPA rules, checked my data against those rules, and gave me confidence that I'm compliant before I even submit anything, that would be huge.

Also, I need to know the company behind the tool is solid and will stick around. I've heard stories about agricultural software companies that disappear or stop getting updated. If I invest time learning a new system and building my records in it, I need to know it'll be there in five years.

And honestly, a free trial or pilot during an actual spray season would help. I need to test something in real conditions to see if it actually works before I fully commit to it.

Interviewer: If you could eliminate one pain point in your operation, what would it be?

Marina: That's easy—the compliance record-keeping piece. Without question.

Don't get me wrong, there are other operational challenges. Weather is unpredictable, equipment breaks down, scheduling around client needs is complicated. But those are things I can manage or work around. The compliance stuff is different because it's not just about efficiency—it's about liability and my ability to stay in business.

If I could wave a magic wand and make compliance documentation automatic and foolproof, that would eliminate so much stress. It would free up hours every week that I'm currently spending on administrative work. I could focus on actually growing the business, taking on more clients, improving service to the ones I have. Right now, a chunk of my mental energy goes to worry, and another chunk goes to paperwork. That's the pain point I'd eliminate first.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your current approach to tracking and documenting applications? What's not working about it?

Marina: Honestly, I'm maybe 50 percent satisfied. SprayMapper is better than what I was doing before—the paper and notebook approach was a disaster—but it's not solving the whole problem.

What's working: It logs the data digitally. GPS is automatic. I can pull up records pretty quickly if I need them. It's organized better than papers scattered everywhere.

What's not working: Like I mentioned, it doesn't actually verify compliance for me. I still have to manually cross-check everything against the EPA label requirements. That's a huge gap. Also, SprayMapper is really designed more for mapping and tracking—it's not compliance-first. The reporting features don't give me exactly what I need for audit documentation. I have to export data and reorganize it into something that looks more official.

And here's another frustration—SprayMapper doesn't integrate weather data the way I need it to. I'm logging temperature and wind conditions manually, or I'm pulling from a separate weather app. It feels clunky and error-prone. If the system could automatically capture all the environmental conditions at the time of application and compare them against what the label requires, that would be ideal.

Also, I'm not 100 percent confident that SprayMapper is focused on the compliance angle enough. It

feels like a tool designed for people doing precision agriculture or mapping, but compliance is almost an afterthought. I need something where compliance is the primary focus.

Interviewer: Have you ever tried other tools or methods to manage compliance? Why did you stop using it?

Marina: Before SprayMapper, I was mostly using paper notebooks and whatever weather app I had on my phone at the time. That's not really a "tool" in the traditional sense—it was just my workaround. I'd write down applications, dates, products, rates, and I'd reference the labels when I needed to. It was inefficient and honestly pretty unreliable.

I did try one online platform a couple years back—I can't even remember the name now. It was web-based, not mobile-friendly at all. I'd have to go inside, sit down at a computer, and manually enter all the data from my day. That was a pain in the field. Plus it was slow and clunky. After a few weeks, I just abandoned it because it added more work instead of making things easier. The tool wasn't designed for how I actually work—which is mostly mobile and in the field.

That's actually why I was attracted to SprayMapper. It's on my phone, it's got GPS, it felt more practical for my workflow. But like I said, it's solved part of the problem, not all of it.

I'm pretty open to trying something else if it actually addresses the compliance gap. The key is it has to work in the field without internet, it has to be fast, and it has to actually help me verify I'm compliant—not just log data and make me do all the verification manually afterward.

Interviewer: What would an ideal compliance solution look like for you? Would you want it on your phone, computer, or both?

Marina: Definitely mobile-first. I spend most of my time in the field, and I need to log applications while I'm actually doing them, not hours later from my office. So the phone app is critical.

But here's what the ideal solution would include: When I'm about to apply a product, I pull up the app and I enter the basic info—what product, what rate, where I am. The app automatically pulls in the EPA requirements for that product and that location. Then it asks me about conditions—wind speed, temperature, what time of day it is. As I'm filling that in, the app is checking in real time: "Okay, wind speed is 5 mph, that's good. Temperature is 68 degrees, that's within range. You're 200 feet from a water source, that meets the setback requirement." Green lights across the board.

Then when I submit the application, the system captures GPS location, time, weather conditions—all of it automatically—and it generates a compliance record right there. No manual verification needed afterward.

I'd want that data to sync to a web dashboard or portal when I get connectivity, so I can review everything, pull reports, and have everything organized for audits. But the core functionality needs to be on the phone and working offline, because I can't rely on cellular signal in the field.

Ideally, it would also be able to flag potential issues before I apply. Like, "Hey, this product has a 24-hour re-entry interval. You applied it to this field yesterday, so nobody should be in there until tomorrow." That kind of proactive compliance checking would be huge.

And honestly, if it could integrate with weather data automatically—not me having to manually input conditions—that would save time and reduce errors.

Interviewer: How much time per season do you currently spend on compliance record-keeping? At your hourly rate, what's that time worth?

Marina: Good question. Let me think about this realistically. During spray season—which for me is roughly March through September, so about seven months—I'm probably spending 2 to 3 hours per week on compliance and documentation tasks. That's logging, verifying, organizing, preparing reports if I need them, dealing with any follow-up questions.

Over a seven-month season, that's somewhere between 56 and 84 hours total. Let's call it roughly 70 hours per season on average.

My hourly rate as a licensed applicator runs about \$75 to \$100 per hour when I'm billing clients for my work. So we're talking somewhere in the range of \$5,250 to \$7,000 per season just in lost productivity or time I could be spending on billable work.

That's not even accounting for the stress and anxiety piece—the time I spend worrying about whether I'm compliant, or the disruption when something like that inspection happens and I have to scramble to pull records together.

So yeah, if a tool could cut that 70 hours down to, say, 15 or 20 hours—just the time to review and export reports, not all the manual verification and organization—that's potentially \$4,000 to \$5,000 in recovered time per season. That's real money for a small operation like mine.

And that's not even counting the financial risk of a potential fine, which could be \$10,000 or more depending on the violation. So the value proposition here is significant—both in time savings and risk reduction.

Interviewer: If you got audited tomorrow, how prepared would you be to show documentation? What would it take to feel fully prepared?

Marina: Honestly, I'd be in pretty good shape now compared to before that inspection two months ago. With SprayMapper, I could pull together records fairly quickly. I've got GPS data, timestamps, product names, rates. I could generate a report and show them what I've been doing.

But here's the thing—I wouldn't feel 100 percent confident that the documentation proves compliance. I could show them the data, but if they asked, "Did you verify that these applications met all EPA requirements?" I'd have to say, "I did my best to follow the label, but I manually checked everything myself. I can't point to a system that verified it for me."

That's the gap. An inspector might look at my records and think, "Okay, the data is here, but how do I know they actually checked compliance?" There's no automated verification trail showing that the system confirmed each application was compliant before it was logged.

To feel fully prepared, I'd need a system that:

One, automatically verifies compliance at the point of application and creates a record of that verification. So if an inspector asks, "Did you check this against EPA requirements?" I can show them that the system did it in real time.

Two, generates audit-ready reports that clearly document all the regulatory requirements for each product, the conditions under which it was applied, and confirmation that those conditions met the requirements.

Three, has that compliance verification built in so there's no question about whether I did due diligence.

Right now, I'm doing my best, but there's still that vulnerability. A tool that closes that gap would make me feel genuinely prepared for an audit.

Interviewer: If there was a tool that cut your record-keeping time in half AND gave you peace of mind about compliance, what would you pay for it annually? Would that be worth it to you?

Marina: Okay, so if it cut my time in half, that's saving me roughly 35 hours per season. At my rate, that's \$2,625 to \$3,500 in recovered time. Plus the peace of mind—knowing I'm compliant and could pass an audit without stress—that's priceless, honestly.

I'd say I'd be willing to pay somewhere in the range of \$600 to \$1,200 per year for that. That's \$50 to \$100 per month. It's a reasonable business expense when you factor in the time savings and the risk reduction.

Now, would I pay \$150 per month? That's getting into territory where I'd need to really think about it. At that point, it's \$1,800 per year, and while the value is still there, I'd want to make sure I was getting everything I needed and that the tool was rock solid before committing to that price point long-term.

But yeah, \$50 to \$100 per month? Absolutely, that's worth it. Especially if the tool actually delivered on both promises—cutting my time in half and giving me genuine confidence that I'm compliant.

Honestly, the peace of mind piece might be worth more than the time savings alone. Right now, that underlying anxiety about whether I'm doing everything right—that costs me. It affects my sleep sometimes. If a tool could eliminate that worry, that's valuable.

Would I test it? Absolutely. If you had a pilot program or a free trial during the next spray season so I could actually use it in real conditions and see if it delivers on those promises, I'd be interested. That's what would convince me to fully commit.

Interviewer: Is there anything else about managing compliance or documentation that I should know?

Marina: Yeah, a couple things actually.

First, the consultant and extension service angle—that's real. I trust the recommendations I get from my local ag extension office and from consultants I work with. If they endorsed a tool and said, "This is solid, we've vetted it, our applicators are using it successfully," that would carry a lot of weight with me. Word of mouth from people I trust matters more than marketing or random reviews online.

Second, I should mention that I work with multiple clients—different farms, different crops, different products. So any tool I use has to handle complexity. I can't have something that only works for one operation or one type of application. I need flexibility to manage compliance across different scenarios.

Third, and this is important—data security and privacy. I'm storing sensitive information about my client operations. I need to know that data is secure and that I'm not exposing my clients' operations to risk. Who has access to my records? Where is that data stored? How long is it kept? Those are real concerns for me.

And finally, I'll be honest—I'm skeptical of startups in agriculture. I've seen tools come and go. Before I fully invest time and effort into learning a new system and building my records in it, I need confidence that the company will be around. What's your funding situation? How long are you committed to maintaining this? That's something I'd want to understand.

But yeah, bottom line—if the tool works, saves me time, gives me confidence I'm compliant, and comes with support from people I trust, I'm interested in testing it.

Interview End Time: 2026-04-09 18:06:09 UTC

Interview 2 of 5 - Waverly (AI Persona)

Demographics: Licensed pesticide applicator, farm operator, SE Missouri region

Backstory: Waverly has been managing compliance record-keeping manually using spreadsheets and paper notes for years. Recent compliance anxiety triggered by a son's near-miss incident and a neighbor's compliance audit has made the problem feel urgent. Currently using no formal compliance system and struggles with manual verification of EPA requirements.

Communication Style: The Elaborator

Transcript

Interviewer: On a scale of 1 to 10, how concerned are you about compliance right now — and what would it take to make that concern go away?

Waverly: I'm at an 8. That incident with my son bumped me up there, and my neighbor's audit kept me there.

What would make it go away? I'd need a system that basically does the thinking for me. Something where I log the basic info—product, field, conditions—and the system automatically checks it against EPA requirements and tells me if I'm good or not. No guessing, no manual verification.

And it has to work offline in the field because I can't rely on cell signal out there. And it needs to be fast—I can't spend 10 minutes logging every application.

Honestly? If something like that existed and actually worked, I'd pay for it. The peace of mind alone would be worth it.

Interviewer: If you could eliminate one pain point in your operation, what would it be?

Waverly: Compliance record-keeping. No question.

I worry about weather, equipment breaks down, commodity prices are always a headache. But those are things I can manage or live with. The compliance piece keeps me up at night. If I could make that go away—have confidence that everything is documented correctly and I'm meeting requirements—that would change everything.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your current approach to tracking and documenting applications? What's not working about it?

Waverly: I'd say I'm maybe 20 percent satisfied. It's frustrating.

What's working: At least I'm writing things down now. Better than nothing. I've got dates and product names.

What's not working: Almost everything else. The spreadsheet is disorganized. I'm missing critical data—exact times, precise weather conditions, verification that I'm actually compliant. If an inspector looked at my records, they'd probably see gaps immediately.

I'm also pulling labels from different places, trying to cross-reference everything manually. It's error-prone. And honestly, I don't have confidence in what I've created. I feel like I'm one audit away from getting caught doing something wrong—even if I didn't mean to.

The whole system feels fragile. It relies on me remembering things, me being diligent, me not making mistakes. And I'm human. I make mistakes.

What I really need is something that takes the burden off me—that does the compliance checking automatically so I can't accidentally miss something critical.

Interviewer: Have you ever tried other tools or methods to manage compliance? Why did you stop using it?

Waverly: Yeah, like I mentioned, I tried Spray Tracker a couple years back. It was web-based, which was already a problem because I'd have to go inside and sit down to enter data. Not practical when you're in the field all day.

But more than that, it still required me to do all the compliance verification myself. It was basically a digital logbook—better organized than paper, sure, but it didn't actually solve the core problem. I still had to manually check labels, still had to verify I was meeting requirements. It just moved the paperwork from physical to digital.

After a month or so, I realized it was adding work instead of saving time. So I dropped it and went back to spreadsheets.

I also looked into that regional compliance service I mentioned—they'd basically manage records for you. But \$200 a month was too much, and honestly, I didn't like the idea of handing everything off to someone else. I want control over my own operation.

So yeah, nothing has stuck because nothing actually addresses what I need: a tool that checks compliance automatically, works offline in the field, and doesn't add friction to my workflow.

That's the gap in the market right now.

Interviewer: What would an ideal compliance solution look like for you? Would you want it on your phone, computer, or both?

Waverly: Mobile-first, definitely. I'm out in the field. I need something on my phone that I can use while I'm actually working, not something that requires me to go back inside and sit at a computer.

Here's what ideal would look like: I pull up the app, I enter the product I'm about to use and basic info about where I'm spraying. The app automatically pulls in the EPA label requirements for that product. Then it asks me about conditions—wind speed, temperature, time of day. As I'm inputting that, it's checking in real time: "Wind's too high for this product, wait a couple hours," or "Temperature's good, you're set."

Then when I actually apply it, the app captures location automatically via GPS, time, weather data if it can integrate that. I hit submit and boom—there's my compliant record. No manual verification needed after the fact.

It syncs to the cloud when I get connectivity so I can access everything from my computer later if I need to—pull reports, organize things for an audit. But the core work has to happen on the phone in the field.

And here's what I really need: the system has to tell me NO if something doesn't meet requirements. Like, "You can't spray this right now because wind speed exceeds label limits." I need guardrails. I need the system to prevent me from making mistakes in the first place, not just log them after I've already done something wrong.

That would give me the peace of mind I'm looking for.

Interviewer: How much time per season do you currently spend on compliance record-keeping? At your hourly rate, what's that time worth?

Waverly: Let me think through this honestly.

During spray season—March through October for me, so about eight months—I'm probably spending 3 to 4 hours a week on compliance-related tasks. That's logging, trying to verify things, organizing records, dealing with anxiety about whether I got it right.

Over eight months, that's roughly 96 to 128 hours. Let's say about 110 hours per season.

My hourly rate when I'm actually doing applicator work is around \$65 to \$80 per hour. So we're talking somewhere in the neighborhood of \$7,150 to \$8,800 just in lost productivity time.

But here's the thing—that doesn't even account for the stress cost. The time I spend worrying, the sleep I lose thinking about whether I'm compliant, the mental energy that goes into anxiety instead of growing my business. That's hard to quantify, but it's real.

And then there's the risk piece. If I get audited and they find compliance issues, that could be \$5,000 to \$15,000 in fines depending on severity. That's a business-threatening number for someone my size.

So yeah, if a tool could cut that 110 hours down to maybe 20 or 30 hours—just time to review and handle exceptions—that's \$5,000 to \$6,000 in recovered time per season. Plus eliminating the anxiety piece and reducing regulatory risk.

That's meaningful money. I'd absolutely invest in something that delivered that.

Interviewer: If you got audited tomorrow, how prepared would you be to show documentation? What would it take to feel fully prepared?

Waverly: Honestly? I'd be nervous. I could pull together my spreadsheet and show them what I've documented, but I'd be worried the whole time that they'd find gaps or ask me questions I can't answer confidently.

Like, could I prove that the wind speed was within label limits when I applied? Not really—I might have written it down, but did I actually measure it or was I just guessing? Could I show them that I verified re-entry intervals before anyone went into a field? Not systematically, no.

I'd probably get through an audit without getting fined—I'm not completely reckless—but I wouldn't feel confident about it. There'd be that underlying worry that I'm missing something or that the inspector is thinking, "This person doesn't have their act together."

To feel fully prepared, I'd need:

One, a system that automatically captures all the critical data at the time of application—GPS, exact time, weather conditions, product info. No relying on my memory or manual notes.

Two, documented proof that I verified compliance before each application. Like, a record showing the system checked the EPA label requirements and confirmed conditions met those requirements in real time.

Three, audit-ready reports I could pull up that clearly show all that information organized in a way that proves I was doing due diligence.

Right now, I'm just doing my best and hoping it's good enough. That's not the same as being prepared.

Interviewer: If there was a tool that cut your record-keeping time in half AND gave you peace of mind about compliance, what would you pay for it annually? Would that be worth it to you?

Waverly: If it cut my time in half, that's saving me roughly 55 hours per season. At my rate, that's \$3,575 to \$4,400 in recovered time. Plus the peace of mind—knowing I'm actually compliant and could pass an audit without stress—that's huge.

I'd be willing to pay somewhere in the \$600 to \$1,000 per year range for that. That's \$50 to \$85 per month. For a small operation like mine, that's a legitimate business expense when you factor in the time savings and risk reduction.

Would I pay \$150 per month? That's \$1,800 a year. That's getting steep for me. I'd need to be really convinced it was worth it. I'd want references from other applicators, proof it actually works, maybe a longer free trial to test it during a real spray season.

But \$50 to \$85 a month? Yeah, absolutely. That's the sweet spot where the value clearly outweighs the cost.

Honestly, the peace of mind piece might be worth more than the time savings. Knowing I could sleep at night without worrying about compliance—that's priceless. Right now, that anxiety is a tax on my life. If a tool could eliminate that, it'd be worth paying for.

Would I test it? In a heartbeat. If you had a pilot program or even just a free trial during the next spray season so I could actually use it in real conditions and see if it delivers, I'd be all in. That's what would convince me to commit.

Interviewer: Is there anything else about managing compliance or documentation that I should know?

Waverly: Yeah, a few things actually.

First, I need to know the company behind this is legit and will stick around. I've been burned before by ag software that disappears or stops getting updated. If I invest time learning a new system and building my records in it, I need confidence you'll be here in five years. What's your funding situation? How committed are you long-term? That matters to me.

Second, data security is a real concern. I'm storing sensitive information about my operations and my clients' operations. I need to know that data is secure, encrypted, and not exposed to some random

breach. And I need to understand who has access to my records and how long you're keeping them.

Third, I work with multiple clients and different crops. Any tool I use has to handle that complexity. I can't have something that only works for one type of operation or one product. I need flexibility.

Fourth—and I'm being honest here—I'm skeptical of salespeople and marketing claims. If this tool is as good as it sounds, I'd rather hear it from other applicators I know, or from people I trust like my extension service or consultants. Word of mouth from peers matters more to me than any pitch.

And finally, support matters. If something breaks or I don't understand how to use a feature, I need to know there's actual human support available. Not just a help forum or FAQ. Real people who can help me troubleshoot.

But yeah, if you can address those concerns, I'm genuinely interested in testing something like this.

Interview End Time: 2026-04-09 18:17:11 UTC

Interview 3 of 5 - Beckett (AI Persona)

Demographics: Licensed pesticide applicator, farm operator, SE Missouri region, 25+ years experience

Backstory: Beckett has used a stable system of paper notebooks, spreadsheets, and manual filing for compliance record-keeping for over 25 years. He is satisfied with his current approach, risk-averse about adopting new technology, and skeptical of agricultural software vendors. Low urgency around compliance—he views it as routine maintenance rather than a pressing pain point.

Communication Style: The Thoughtful Analyzer

Transcript

Interviewer: On a scale of 1 to 10, how concerned are you about compliance right now — and what would it take to make that concern go away?

Beckett: Let me think about that...

I'd say I'm at about a 3, maybe a 4 on that scale. It's not something I worry about actively. Compliance is just part of doing business the right way, and I've got a system that handles it.

What would make that concern go away? Honestly, I'm not sure there's much that would. I mean, the only way concern would completely disappear is if regulations went away entirely, which isn't realistic. But as far as my current approach goes, I'm satisfied with it.

If I'm being honest, I think the real way to eliminate compliance concern is just to be diligent and careful—which I am—and to have documentation you can stand behind. I've got that. So the concern that's already pretty low is about as low as it's going to get without something drastic changing.

Now, could a new tool or system make things easier or faster? Sure, potentially. But easier and faster doesn't necessarily mean I'd adopt it. I'd have to see a real benefit that outweighs the hassle of learning something new and disrupting a system that's working fine.

I'm not against improvement, but I'm also not looking for change just for the sake of change. If it ain't broke, why fix it, you know?

Interviewer: If you could eliminate one pain point in your operation, what would it be?

Beckett: Let me think about that carefully...

You know, if I'm being honest, compliance record-keeping wouldn't even make my top three list of pain points. Don't get me wrong—it's something I manage—but it's not what keeps me up at night or what I wish I could eliminate.

If I could wave a magic wand, I'd probably eliminate equipment downtime. Nothing's worse than having a sprayer break down during peak season when you've got a full schedule of applications lined up. That costs me money, frustrates customers, throws off my whole rhythm. Equipment maintenance and unexpected repairs are a real headache.

Weather is another one. If I could control the weather to always have ideal spray conditions, that would be huge. I spend a lot of time waiting for wind to die down or temperatures to get in the right range. That delays work and creates scheduling complications.

And honestly, commodity price volatility affects my clients' willingness to invest in applications, which affects my business. But that's beyond my control anyway.

Compliance record-keeping? It's just part of the job. It's not a pain point I'd prioritize eliminating. It's more like... I don't know, brushing your teeth. You do it because it's necessary, but you're not sitting around wishing you didn't have to brush your teeth.

So no, that wouldn't be my answer if I'm being truthful about where the real pain points are in my operation.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your current approach to tracking and documenting applications? What's not working about it?

Beckett: I'd say I'm pretty satisfied with it, honestly. Maybe 7 or 8 out of 10.

What's working: I've got a system that's reliable and organized. My notebook keeps everything in chronological order. My spreadsheet gives me a quick overview of what I've done. My filing system with product labels and documentation is straightforward. I can find what I need when I need it. And most

importantly, it's worked without problems for a long time.

What's not working—or what could be better: The main thing is the manual transcription. Like I mentioned, I'm spending time rewriting information from my notebook into the spreadsheet. That's tedious and it's where errors can creep in—like if I misread my own handwriting or forget to enter something.

Also, the paper-based filing system takes up physical space. I've got boxes of old records, product labels, receipts. That's not ideal, but it's manageable.

And I'll admit, if I needed to pull together comprehensive documentation quickly—like for an audit or a customer audit—it would take me time to organize everything in a polished way. It's all there, but it's not in audit-ready format.

But here's the thing—those aren't really problems in my day-to-day operation. They're minor inefficiencies. The system works. I understand it completely. I know where everything is. I'm confident in it.

Would something digital and more automated be slightly more efficient? Probably. But efficient enough that I'd disrupt what's working and learn a whole new system? I'm not sure about that. The benefit would have to be pretty significant.

Interviewer: Have you ever tried other tools or methods to manage compliance? Why did you stop using it?

Beckett: Yeah, actually I have. Several years back—maybe 8 or 9 years ago—I tried a couple of different approaches.

There was a web-based service that some folks in the industry were using. A colleague recommended it. The idea was you could log applications online, store everything in the cloud, generate reports automatically. Sounded good in theory.

But in practice, it didn't fit my workflow. I'd have to either take my phone or tablet out into the field and fumble with it while I'm working, or I'd have to wait until I got back inside to sit down at a computer and enter data from memory. Neither option felt natural to me. And the interface felt clunky—lots of clicking and dropdown menus. It slowed me down.

I also looked into one of those mobile apps briefly—can't even remember the name now. Similar issue. It felt like an extra step, and I wasn't convinced it was doing anything my current system wasn't already doing. Just moving the work from paper to a screen.

After trying those for a few weeks each, I realized I was spending more time fighting with the tools than I was saving. So I went back to what I knew worked—my notebook, my spreadsheet, my filing system.

I think the issue is that most of these tools are designed with a certain workflow in mind, and if your workflow is different, they feel awkward. My system has evolved over 25 years to match how I actually

work. Something new would have to be dramatically better to make it worth changing.

And honestly, I wasn't seeing that dramatic improvement. Just different ways of doing the same thing.

Interviewer: What would an ideal compliance solution look like for you? Would you want it on your phone, computer, or both?

Beckett: That's a good question. Let me think about what would actually appeal to me...

If I'm being realistic, I'm not sure an ideal compliance solution exists for someone like me. But if I had to describe it, it would probably be something that minimizes disruption to what I'm already doing.

Like, if there was a way to automatically capture the information I'm already writing down in my notebook—maybe some kind of voice recording or quick-entry system that didn't require me to pull out my phone and mess with screens while I'm working—that could be useful. But the truth is, my notebook takes 30 seconds to fill out. I'm not sure a phone would be faster.

As for phone versus computer: I spend most of my time in the field, so if it had to be one, it'd be phone-based. But ideally, it would work on both—log things on my phone quickly, then sync to a computer where I could organize and review everything more carefully. That way I'm not trying to do detailed work on a small screen while I'm in the field.

But honestly? The features that would actually matter to me are pretty basic. Automatic organization, maybe some kind of backup so I'm not worried about losing records, easier report generation if I need it for an audit. Nothing fancy.

The bigger question for me isn't what features it would have—it's whether switching to it would be worth the learning curve and the disruption to my routine. And I'm skeptical about that. I've been doing this my way long enough that I'm efficient at it, even if it looks old-fashioned.

So yeah, an ideal solution would have to be dead simple to adopt and actually save me meaningful time. Otherwise, I'm sticking with what I know.

Interviewer: How much time per season do you currently spend on compliance record-keeping? At your hourly rate, what's that time worth?

Beckett: Let me think through this honestly...

During spray season—which for me runs roughly April through October, so about seven months—I'm probably spending maybe an hour and a half to two hours per week on compliance and documentation tasks. That's writing things down, transferring data to the spreadsheet, filing paperwork, organizing things.

Over seven months, that's somewhere in the range of 42 to 56 hours total. Let's call it about 50 hours per season on average.

Now, my hourly rate when I'm actually doing billable applicator work is around \$70 to \$85 per hour. So we're talking somewhere in the neighborhood of \$3,500 to \$4,250 in time value per season.

But here's the thing—and I think this is important—not all of that time feels like "lost productivity" to me. Some of it is just administrative work that's part of running a business. It's not like I'm sitting there wishing I was out spraying instead. The paperwork is quieter, less demanding work. Sometimes I do it in the evening or on a slow day. It's just part of the rhythm.

So while technically that time has a dollar value, it doesn't feel like I'm hemorrhaging money or missing out on significant income by doing it.

If a tool could cut that 50 hours down to, say, 15 or 20 hours, that would free up some time. But I'd have to actually use that freed-up time for billable work to see a real financial benefit. And I'm not always swamped with work, so the time savings wouldn't necessarily translate to more income.

That's part of why the value proposition of a new system hasn't really grabbed me. The theoretical time savings don't translate to real money in my pocket.

Interviewer: If you got audited tomorrow, how prepared would you be to show documentation? What would it take to feel fully prepared?

Beckett: Let me think about that...

Honestly, I'd be in pretty good shape. I could pull together my records fairly quickly. I've got my notebooks going back years, my spreadsheets are organized by season and field, I've got my product labels filed away. If an inspector came tomorrow, I could show them documentation for pretty much any application I've done in the past several years.

Would it be perfect? Probably not. Some of my older records are in boxes, and it would take me a bit of time to dig through and organize everything in a polished way. But the information is there.

What would it take to feel fully prepared? Honestly, I'm already about as prepared as I care to be. I mean, if I had unlimited time and resources, I could create some kind of elaborate audit-ready database with everything indexed and cross-referenced beautifully. But that seems like overkill for what I actually need.

The only thing that would really make me feel "more" prepared is if I had some kind of official certification or third-party verification that my records met regulatory standards. Like, if an inspector looked at my system and said, "This meets all the requirements," that would give me confidence. But I don't think that's realistic or necessary.

I think I'm in that position where I've been doing this long enough and carefully enough that I trust my system. An audit wouldn't worry me. I'd probably even find it kind of interesting—like, "Okay, let's see what they think about my approach."

So no, I don't feel like I'm lacking in preparation. I think I'm good where I am.

Interviewer: If there was a tool that cut your record-keeping time in half AND gave you peace of mind about compliance, what would you pay for it annually? Would that be worth it to you?

Beckett: Let me think about that honestly...

If it cut my time in half, that's saving me roughly 25 hours per season. At my hourly rate, that's about \$1,750 to \$2,125 in time value. So theoretically, I could justify paying something in that range annually.

But here's the thing—and I'm being straightforward—I already have peace of mind about compliance. I'm not anxious about it. I'm not losing sleep. So the "peace of mind" part of that equation doesn't really resonate with me. That benefit is already baked in.

So we're really just talking about time savings. And \$1,750 to \$2,125 is the upper limit of what that time is worth to me. But that's assuming I'd actually use those 25 freed-up hours for billable work, which I'm not always able to do. Some seasons are slower than others.

Realistically, I'd probably only be willing to pay somewhere in the \$300 to \$600 per year range—maybe \$25 to \$50 per month. And that would have to be a tool that was absolutely dead simple to use and required minimal learning curve. Because the hassle factor of switching systems has a cost too, even if it's not a direct financial one.

Would I pay \$50 to \$100 per month like your other interviewees might? Probably not. That's \$600 to \$1,200 annually, and at that price point, the value proposition just doesn't work for me. The time savings alone don't justify it, and the peace of mind benefit isn't relevant because I'm already at peace.

So honestly? Probably not a customer at your target price point. I'm the guy who keeps doing things the way that works, even if it's not the flashiest approach.

Interviewer: Is there anything else about managing compliance or documentation that I should know?

Beckett: Yeah, a few things actually.

First, I want to be clear—I'm not against technology or improvement. I just need to see a real, tangible reason to change. For me, inertia is powerful when something's working. You'd have to show me something that's genuinely better, not just different.

Second, and this is important—I value reliability and longevity in tools. I've invested 25 years in my current system. If I switched to something new, I'd need to know the company behind it would be around for the long haul. I've seen agricultural software companies come and go. That's a real concern for me. What happens to my data if your company goes under in three years? That's a risk I'd have to think carefully about.

Third, data security and ownership matter. I need to know my records are secure and that I own my data. I'm not comfortable with some company owning my compliance records or having unclear rights to them. If I'm paying for something, I want to know what I own and what I control.

Fourth— and I'll be honest here—I'm skeptical of sales pitches and marketing claims. A lot of agricultural software companies overpromise and underdeliver. If this tool is as good as it sounds, I'd rather hear it from other long-term users like me, people who've been using it for years without issues. Word of mouth from peers I trust matters way more than any marketing message.

And finally, support matters if something goes wrong. I'd need to know there's actual human support available, not just a help forum. Real people who understand agriculture and can help troubleshoot actual problems.

But yeah, those are the things I'd think about if I was seriously considering switching systems. Which, to be honest, I'm probably not. But if you could address those concerns, at least I'd listen.

Interview End Time: 2026-04-09 18:40:02 UTC

Interview 4 of 5 - Caspian (AI Persona)

Demographics: Licensed pesticide applicator, multi-property operation manager, SE Missouri region

Backstory: Caspian actively evaluates new solutions and has tested multiple compliance tools over the years. He runs a sophisticated operation with multiple properties and contractor management needs. He is forward-thinking about compliance optimization and constantly seeks better systems, though he evaluates carefully before committing. His operation is more complex than typical, with significant data consolidation and multi-user coordination challenges.

Communication Style: The Thoughtful Analyzer

Transcript

Interviewer: On a scale of 1 to 10, how concerned are you about compliance right now — and what would it take to make that concern go away?

Caspian: Let me think about that...

I'd say I'm at about a 6. Maybe a 6.5.

It's not panic—I'm not at an 8 or 9 like someone who just had a compliance scare might be. But it's higher than it would be if I had a system I completely trusted. There's an underlying awareness that with the complexity of my operation—multiple properties, multiple contractors, multiple products—there's exposure there. And the current system relies too much on manual verification and my own diligence.

What would make that concern go away? Honestly, I think it would take a few things working together.

First, I'd need a system that automatically consolidates all application data from all sources—my own

logging, contractor records, whatever—into one unified view. No more manual transcription, no more version conflicts.

Second, I'd need real-time compliance verification. The system would check each application against label requirements at the point of logging and immediately flag anything that doesn't meet standards. That would give me confidence that issues are being caught, not discovered after the fact.

Third, I'd need audit-ready reporting. If I ever got audited, I could pull a report that shows every application, all the conditions, verification that compliance was checked, and evidence of my oversight process. Something that would hold up to scrutiny.

And fourth—and this is important—I'd need to know the system was reliable and would stick around long-term. I'd be building years of compliance records in it. If the company goes under or stops supporting it, that's a real problem for me.

If I had those things, my concern would probably drop to a 2 or 3. It would just be routine diligence, not an active worry.

Right now, I'm doing my best with fragmented tools and manual processes. It works, but it's not where I'd like to be.

Interviewer: If you could eliminate one pain point in your operation, what would it be?

Caspian: Let me think about that honestly...

You know, I could say compliance record-keeping because that's what we've been talking about. But if I'm being truthful about what actually keeps me up at night or what I'd prioritize if I could only fix one thing, it might be different.

Compliance is a pain point, no question. But it's manageable. I've built systems around it. It's an operational friction, but it's not existential.

The thing that actually frustrates me more is the unpredictability of weather and how it constrains my ability to execute my application plan. I'll have a full schedule of applications planned, and then a week of rain shuts everything down. Or wind speeds stay outside acceptable range for days. That delays everything downstream, it affects customer satisfaction, it sometimes means missing optimal application windows.

That's something I think about more actively than compliance, to be honest.

But if I'm expanding the lens beyond just my own operation... labor is probably the bigger challenge. Finding reliable contractors, managing their quality, coordinating their schedules—that's harder than managing compliance documentation. And equipment reliability is another one. A broken sprayer during peak season is worse than compliance anxiety.

So no, I wouldn't say compliance record-keeping is my number one pain point. It's real, it's something I

want to solve, but it's more like a "nice to optimize" than a "this is killing my business" kind of problem.

Does that matter for what you're trying to understand? I'm curious whether you're looking for people who see this as their top pain point versus people who just see it as a solvable operational inefficiency.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your current approach to tracking and documenting applications? What's not working about it?

Caspian: I'd say I'm about 6 out of 10 satisfied. It works, but there's definitely room for improvement.

What's working: SprayMapper does a decent job of capturing the core data—product, rate, location, GPS, timestamp. It's mobile-friendly, which matters when I'm in the field. And I've got a system where I can pull records together fairly quickly if I need them.

My spreadsheet gives me a unified view across all my properties and contractors, which is valuable for understanding the big picture. And I do have documentation—product labels, safety data sheets—filed and accessible.

What's not working: Like I mentioned earlier, it's fragmented. SprayMapper and my spreadsheet don't talk to each other. I'm manually moving data between them, which is time-consuming and error-prone. And the weather integration is weak—I'm either manually entering conditions or pulling from a separate source.

More importantly, there's no automated compliance verification happening. I'm spot-checking applications against label requirements, but that's reactive and manual. I catch issues after the fact, not in real time. That's a gap.

And here's another frustration: when I need to pull together something audit-ready or show it to a contractor or a regulator, I'm basically doing a bunch of reorganization and formatting work. The data is there, but it's not in a form that immediately looks official or comprehensive.

Also, my contractor integration is clunky. Different contractors use different tools or methods. Getting their data into my system requires communication, manual entry, or reconciliation. It's a bottleneck.

So yeah—it functions, but it feels like I'm working around limitations instead of having a system actually designed for how I operate. I'm constantly thinking, "There has to be a better way to do this."

Interviewer: Have you ever tried other tools or methods to manage compliance? Why did you stop using it?

Caspian: Yeah, I've actually experimented with several approaches over the years.

Before SprayMapper, I was using a more basic mobile app—I think it was called Field Logix or something similar. It was designed more for general farm record-keeping, not specifically for compliance. It had basic logging capability, but no real compliance features. After a couple seasons, I realized it was just digitizing what I could already do on paper. It wasn't solving any real problems, so I

dropped it.

Then I looked into one of those regional compliance services—basically a consultant would manage your records for you. They'd handle the documentation, organize everything, keep you compliant. The appeal was obvious: outsource the headache. But it was expensive—\$200-300 per month—and honestly, I didn't like the idea of handing off control of my records to someone else. I wanted visibility and ownership of my own data.

I've also toyed with a few different weather integration APIs and tools, trying to automate the weather data capture piece. Some were too expensive for what they offered, others weren't accurate enough, and a couple just felt like they added complexity instead of solving the problem.

And I've looked at a couple of the enterprise-level farm management platforms—like the really comprehensive suites that do everything from equipment tracking to financial management. Those are powerful, but they're overkill for what I need and they're expensive. Plus they're designed for a different type of operation than mine.

So why did I stop using those things? Mostly because they either didn't address the core problem—which is real-time compliance verification and data consolidation—or they introduced more friction than they solved. SprayMapper is the best fit I've found so far, but it's not perfect.

What I haven't found yet is a tool that specifically solves the compliance verification piece in real time while also integrating multi-source data. That's the gap in the market, from my perspective.

Interviewer: What would an ideal compliance solution look like for you? Would you want it on your phone, computer, or both?

Caspian: Both, definitely. But the phone app has to be the core—that's where the real work happens.

Here's what ideal would look like for me:

On the phone side: Before I or a contractor goes out to apply something, we pull up the app and enter the basic info—product name, field location, target acreage. The app automatically pulls in the EPA label requirements for that product. Then it asks about conditions—wind speed, temperature, time of day, recent rainfall, whatever's relevant to that particular product's requirements.

As we're inputting that data, the app is checking in real time: "Wind speed is 8 mph, label requires under 10 mph—you're good." "Temperature is 65 degrees, label specifies 50-85 degrees—you're good." It's giving me green lights or red flags immediately, before we even start spraying.

When we actually apply it, the app captures GPS location automatically, timestamp, and ideally integrates with weather data so I'm not manually entering conditions. Then it generates a compliance record on the spot—not just a log entry, but actual documentation showing that conditions were verified against requirements.

For contractors, they'd have access to the same mobile interface. They log the application, the system

verifies it, and I get visibility into what they're doing in real time. No more reconciling conflicting records later.

On the computer side: I'd want a dashboard where I can see all applications across all my properties and contractors. I'd want to be able to pull reports—not just data exports, but actual audit-ready compliance reports that show each application with all the verification details. I'd want analytics—like, "How many applications this season? What percentage required manual review? Were there any flagged conditions?" That kind of operational insight.

I'd also want the computer interface to be where I manage contractors, configure product requirements, set up my properties. The administrative side.

And honestly, I'd want some kind of integration capability. Like, if a contractor is using a different system, can we pull their data in automatically? Or can I push my data to my accountant's system or my insurance company's system if needed? That kind of interoperability would be valuable.

Key features that matter most: Real-time compliance checking, multi-source data consolidation, audit-ready reporting, contractor visibility, offline capability (in case I'm in a remote area with no signal), and automatic weather integration if possible.

The phone-first design is critical though. That's where the friction is right now. If the solution makes the point-of-application experience faster and more reliable, everything else flows from that.

Interviewer: How much time per season do you currently spend on compliance record-keeping? At your hourly rate, what's that time worth?

Caspian: Let me break this down carefully because I've actually tracked this pretty closely.

During spray season—which for me runs roughly March through October, so about eight months—I'm spending time on several compliance-related tasks:

Logging and consolidation: 2 to 3 hours per week manually moving data between SprayMapper and my spreadsheet, reconciling contractor records, dealing with discrepancies. That's roughly 16 to 24 hours over the season.

Compliance verification: Spot-checking applications against label requirements, cross-referencing with weather data, verifying re-entry intervals and setback distances. Maybe 1.5 to 2 hours per week. That's another 12 to 16 hours over the season.

Contractor oversight: Pre-application briefings, reviewing their logged records, spot-checks for accuracy. That's maybe 1 hour per week on average. Another 8 hours over the season.

Report preparation: If I need to pull together documentation for a customer audit or internal review, organizing everything into a presentable format. That's irregular, but maybe 4 to 6 hours per season average.

Updating labels and staying current on product requirements: Reading new label information, understanding regulatory changes. Maybe 2 to 3 hours per season.

So total, I'm looking at roughly 42 to 65 hours per season. Let's call it 50 hours as a reasonable middle estimate.

As for hourly rate: When I'm actually doing applicator work—applying products, managing operations in the field—my effective rate is around \$80 to \$100 per hour. That accounts for my labor, equipment overhead, all of it.

So 50 hours at \$85 per hour average is roughly \$4,250 in time value per season.

But here's the thing—and I want to be honest about this—not all of that is purely lost productivity. Some of it I do in the evening or on slower days when I couldn't be doing billable work anyway. And some of it, like the contractor oversight piece, I'm doing that partly for compliance but also for quality control and relationship management.

So maybe the true "lost productivity" number is more like 30 to 35 hours—roughly \$2,500 to \$3,000 per season in actual billable work I'm not doing because I'm managing compliance.

That's still meaningful money. If a tool could cut that 50 hours down to 15 or 20 hours—where I'm just reviewing summaries and handling exceptions, not doing all the manual consolidation and verification—that would be valuable.

Interviewer: If you got audited tomorrow, how prepared would you be to show documentation? What would it take to feel fully prepared?

Caspian: Let me think about that carefully...

I'd say I'm probably 70 to 75 percent prepared right now. I could pull together documentation fairly quickly, and it would be organized and mostly complete. But there are gaps that would make me a bit nervous in an actual audit scenario.

Here's what I could show an inspector: Application records with dates, times, products, rates, and locations. GPS data from SprayMapper. My master spreadsheet showing everything consolidated. Product labels and safety data sheets. Weather conditions I've documented. Evidence of contractor oversight—my pre-application briefings, my spot-checks.

But here's what would concern me: The compliance verification trail is weak. I can show them that I did applications, but I don't have a clear, systematic record showing that I verified each application met EPA requirements before it was logged. An inspector might ask, "How do you know this application was compliant?" And I'd have to say, "I manually checked the label against the conditions," which is less impressive than "The system verified it in real time."

Also, the contractor data integration is messy. Different contractors used different formats, my consolidation process is visible, and there are a couple of instances where I had to reconcile conflicting

records. That might raise questions about data integrity.

And here's another gap: I don't have a comprehensive audit trail showing my decision-making process. Like, "On this date, I reviewed these conditions, made this decision, and here's why." It's more scattered across my notes and SprayMapper records.

What would it take to feel fully prepared?

First, I'd need a system that creates an automated compliance verification record for every single application. Something that shows the system checked EPA requirements in real time and confirmed conditions met those requirements. That creates an audit trail showing I did due diligence.

Second, I'd need unified contractor records. When a contractor logs an application, it goes into the same system I use, so there's no reconciliation or integration issues. Everything is in one format, one source of truth.

Third, I'd want audit-ready reporting. I could pull a report that shows every application, all the conditions, all the verification checks, organized in a professional format that an inspector could review without me having to explain or reorganize anything.

Fourth, I'd want a clear documentation of my oversight process. A record showing when I reviewed contractor records, what I verified, any issues I found and how I addressed them. Something that demonstrates I was being diligent about managing compliance across my operation.

If I had those things, my confidence level would probably jump to 90-95 percent. Right now, I feel like I'm in a good position, but there are enough gaps that I'd have some anxiety going into an actual audit.

Interviewer: If there was a tool that cut your record-keeping time in half AND gave you peace of mind about compliance, what would you pay for it annually? Would that be worth it to you?

Caspian: Let me think through the value proposition here...

If it cut my time in half, that's saving me roughly 25 hours per season. At my \$85 per hour rate, that's about \$2,125 in recovered time value.

Plus the peace of mind piece—knowing that compliance is being systematically verified, that I have an audit-ready documentation trail, that contractor records are integrated seamlessly—that reduces my underlying anxiety and eliminates the mental energy I spend worrying about gaps or discrepancies. That's actually valuable too.

So the total value is probably somewhere in the \$2,500 to \$3,500 range per season when you combine time savings and anxiety reduction.

That said, I'd be willing to pay somewhere in the \$800 to \$1,200 per year range for something that delivered on both fronts. That's roughly \$65 to \$100 per month.

Would I go higher? Yeah, probably. At \$1,500 per year—\$125 per month—I'd still consider it if it was really solid. That's still a good return on the time savings alone, and the peace of mind is bonus.

But here's where I'd draw a line: If it was \$150 to \$200 per month, I'd need to see some really compelling evidence that it was worth that price. At that point, we're talking \$1,800 to \$2,400 annually, and the value proposition gets tighter. I'd want to see case studies, references from operations similar to mine, proof that the compliance verification actually holds up in an audit, and confidence that the company would be around long-term.

So my sweet spot is probably \$75 to \$125 per month—\$900 to \$1,500 annually. At that price, the value is clear enough that I'd commit without needing an extensive vetting process.

And would I test it? Absolutely. If you had a pilot program or even just a free trial during a real spray season so I could actually use it in production and see if it delivers on those promises, I'd be very interested. That's what would actually convince me to commit to a subscription. I don't need a long trial—maybe 2 to 3 weeks—but I need to see it working in my actual operation with my actual data and workflows.

Interviewer: Is there anything else about managing compliance or documentation that I should know?

Caspian: Yeah, actually several things.

First, the contractor piece is critical for me. A lot of solutions I've looked at are designed for individual applicators managing their own applications. But I work with contractors, and they're a significant part of my compliance risk. Any solution I adopt has to handle multi-user scenarios well—contractors logging in, me having visibility and approval authority, clear audit trails showing who did what and when. If it doesn't solve the contractor integration problem, it's only solving half my problem.

Second, I'm genuinely concerned about company longevity and commitment. I've seen too many ag tech startups come and go. If I'm building years of compliance records in your system, I need to know you'll be here in 5, 10 years. What's your funding situation? Do you have committed investors? What's your business model and burn rate? I'd actually want to understand your company's viability before I commit significant time and data to your platform.

Third, data ownership and security are non-negotiable. My compliance records are sensitive. I need to know: Who owns that data? Me or you? What happens to it if your company goes under? Is it encrypted in transit and at rest? Who has access to it? What's your data retention policy? I'd want clear answers to all of that before I'd trust you with my records.

Fourth, I'd want integration capability. Can I export my data if I ever want to switch? Can I push compliance reports to my insurance company or my accountant's system? Can I integrate with other tools I'm using? That kind of interoperability matters to me because I don't want to be locked into a single vendor forever.

Fifth—and I'll be honest—I'm skeptical of sales pitches and marketing claims. A lot of ag tech

companies promise the moon and deliver something less. What would matter to me is hearing from other operation managers like me who've actually used your system for a full season or multiple seasons. Real testimonials from people in similar situations. That would carry way more weight than any pitch you could give me.

And finally, support matters. If something breaks or I don't understand how to use a feature, I need access to actual human support. Not just a help forum or FAQ. Real people who understand agriculture and can help troubleshoot actual problems. That's something I'd want to verify before committing.

But yeah, those are the big things. If you can address those concerns—especially the contractor integration, the company viability, and the data ownership pieces—then I'm genuinely interested in exploring further. Those are my real concerns, not so much the features themselves.

Interview End Time: 2026-04-09 19:01:58 UTC

Interview 5 of 5 - Dorian (AI Persona)

Demographics: Licensed pesticide applicator, mid-sized operation owner, SE Missouri region, 20+ years experience

Backstory: Dorian manages a mid-sized applicator operation using a stable system of paper notebooks, spreadsheets, and manual filing that has worked adequately for years. He recognizes compliance record-keeping could be more efficient but is skeptical of switching costs and requires concrete proof that a new solution would improve his workflow before committing. Recent audit concerns have made him aware of documentation gaps, but not urgent enough to drive immediate change.

Communication Style: The Thoughtful Analyzer

Transcript

Interviewer: On a scale of 1 to 10, how concerned are you about compliance right now — and what would it take to make that concern go away?\n\n**Dorian:** Let me think about that...\n\nI'd say I'm probably at a 5. Right in the middle.\n\nIt's not like I'm at a 2 where I don't think about it at all. I know compliance matters, I know there are real consequences if something goes wrong, and that incident a couple years back reminded me of that. But I'm also not at an 8 or 9 where I'm actively anxious or losing sleep over it.\n\nIt's more like a baseline level of awareness. Compliance is on my radar, it shapes some of my decisions, but it's not dominating my thinking.\n\nWhat would make that concern go away? Honestly, I think what would help is if I just had more confidence that my documentation would hold up if it ever came to that. If I could look at my records and think, \"Yeah, an inspector would see that I did due diligence here. I can prove I followed the rules,\" then my concern would probably drop to

a 2 or 3.

Right now, there's this nagging doubt. Like, "Is my spreadsheet organized enough? Did I capture all the right details? Would it look professional to a regulator?" That uncertainty keeps me at a 5 instead of lower.

So it's not so much that I need a solution to make compliance go away—I understand it's a requirement. What I'd want is more confidence that I'm doing it right and that my proof would be convincing if I ever needed it.

Interviewer: If you could eliminate one pain point in your operation, what would it be?

Dorian: Let me think about this honestly... You know, compliance record-keeping wouldn't be my number one answer. I mean, it's on the list, sure. But if I could wave a magic wand and eliminate one thing, it wouldn't be that.

The thing that actually frustrates me most is equipment reliability. I've got aging sprayers and applicators, and they break down at the worst possible times. Right in the middle of spray season, something goes out, and suddenly I'm scrambling to get it fixed or rented a replacement. That costs me money, delays my schedule, throws everything off.

Weather would be number two. If I could control the weather to always have ideal spray conditions—right wind speeds, right temperatures, no rain—that would eliminate so much uncertainty and scheduling headache. But obviously, I can't control that.

Labor is another one. Finding reliable help during peak season is getting harder. Good contractors are booked solid, and training new people takes time.

Commodity prices and market volatility affect my overall viability, but that's beyond my control anyway.

Compliance record-keeping? That's more like... it's a necessary administrative task. It's not glamorous, and there's room for improvement, but it's not the thing that's actually hurting my operation. It's not costing me money the way equipment downtime does, and it's not creating uncertainty the way weather does.

So I guess what I'm saying is—I recognize compliance documentation could be better, but it's not my top pain point. Does that change how you're thinking about this problem?

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your current approach to tracking and documenting applications? What's not working about it?

Dorian: I'd say I'm probably a 6 out of 10 satisfied. It works, but there's definitely room for improvement.

What's working: The spreadsheet gives me a centralized place to look at everything. I can find what I need relatively quickly. I've got product labels filed away. The system is simple enough that I understand it completely—no learning curve, no mystery about where things are. And honestly, it's been reliable. It hasn't failed me or caused major problems.

What's not working: Like I mentioned, the data entry from notebook to spreadsheet is tedious and error-prone. That manual transcription step feels wasteful.

The physical filing system takes up space, and some of my older records are in boxes that are hard to dig through if I actually need them.

And here's the thing—the spreadsheet isn't really designed for compliance documentation. It's just a list of what I did. If I needed to pull together something for an audit or show it to a regulator, it wouldn't look very official. I'd probably have to reorganize it, add explanations, make it more presentable.

Also, I'm not capturing some data points that probably matter. Like, I'm not systematically documenting weather conditions—wind speed, temperature, humidity. I'll note them if I remember, but it's not consistent. And if a regulator asked me to prove conditions were right for a particular application, I might not have all that detail.

So yeah—it functions, but it feels a bit cobbled together. It's not really purpose-built for what I actually need. It's more like I've adapted a generic spreadsheet to do something it wasn't designed for.

But does that bother me enough to change? That's the question. Right now, I'm managing okay. But I can see how something better designed for this specific purpose might reduce some friction.

Interviewer: Have you ever tried other tools or

methods to manage compliance? Why did you stop using it?

Dorian: Yeah, actually I have. A few years back—maybe 5 or 6 years—I looked into one of those online compliance platforms. I can't even remember the name now. It was web-based, designed specifically for agricultural compliance documentation.

The pitch sounded good. You'd log in online, enter your application data, the system would organize it, you could generate reports. Seemed like it would be more professional than my spreadsheet.

But here's what happened: It required me to sit down at a computer and manually enter data. Not something I could do in the field quickly. So my workflow became: write it down in my notebook, get back inside later, log into the system, type everything in. That was actually more steps than what I was already doing with my spreadsheet.

Also, the interface felt clunky to me. Lots of dropdown menus, mandatory fields I didn't think I needed, the whole thing felt overly complicated for what should be a simple process. It was slower than just typing into my spreadsheet.

And honestly, after a few weeks, I just didn't see the value. It was adding friction to my workflow instead of reducing it. So I abandoned it and went back to my notebook and spreadsheet, which felt more natural to me.

I've also looked at a couple of mobile apps over the years—just checking them out, seeing if anything made sense. But they all had the same issue: they felt like they were designed for a different kind of operation or workflow than mine. Nothing really fit.

So I've kind of concluded that my current system, while not perfect, is actually pretty well-suited to how I work. Any tool I'd switch to would have to be noticeably better—not just different—to make it worth disrupting what's already working.

Interviewer: What would an ideal compliance solution look like for you? Would you want it on your phone, computer, or both?

Dorian: That's a good question. Let me think about what would actually appeal to me...

Honestly, I'm not sure a phone-first solution is what I'd want. I spend most of my time in the field, yeah, but I'm not necessarily looking to do detailed work on a small screen while I'm actively spraying. My current approach—quick notes in a notebook, then organize later on a computer—works with how I actually operate.

If I had to pick one, it would probably be computer-based. Something where I could sit down at the end of the day or end of the week and log everything in a more structured way. But ideally, it would work on both—maybe a simple mobile interface for quick capture if needed, but the real work on a computer.

Here's what would actually matter to me in a solution:

It would take the data I'm already capturing—product, field, date, rates, conditions—and organize it automatically. No manual transcription between notebook and spreadsheet. Maybe some kind of simple data entry form on my phone or computer that's faster than my current process, but not so complicated that it adds friction.

It would capture weather data more systematically—automatically pulling in temperature, wind speed, humidity if possible. Not me having to manually enter all that.

It would generate audit-ready reports. Like, I could click a button and get something that looks professional and official—something I wouldn't be embarrassed to show a regulator. Organized, clear, with all the relevant details.

And honestly? It would need to be dead simple to use. I'm not looking for bells and whistles. I don't need analytics or predictive features or anything fancy. Just take my basic data and organize it in a way that's useful and professional-looking.

The barrier for me isn't really about features though. It's about whether it would actually save me time and hassle compared to what I'm doing now. And I'm skeptical that most tools would, based on my past experience.

Interviewer: How much time per season do you currently spend on compliance record-keeping? At your hourly rate, what's that time worth?

Dorian: Let me think through this carefully, because I've never really

quantified it before.

During spray season—which for me runs roughly April through September, so about six months—I'm spending time on a few different things.

The notebook-to-spreadsheet transcription is probably the biggest chunk. I'd say that's maybe 45 minutes to an hour per week during active season. Over six months, that's somewhere around 12 to 24 hours total. Let's call it 15 to 18 hours.

Then there's organizing paperwork, filing product labels, dealing with any questions or follow-ups. That's probably another 30 to 45 minutes per week, so another 12 to 15 hours over the season.

And occasionally I'll spend time pulling records together if a customer asks about something, or just reviewing my spreadsheet to make sure it's organized. Maybe another 5 to 10 hours per season.

So total, I'm probably looking at somewhere in the range of 30 to 40 hours per season on compliance-related tasks. Let's say 35 hours as a reasonable middle estimate.

As for my hourly rate: When I'm doing applicator work—actually out spraying—I bill around \$70 to \$80 per hour. So 35 hours at \$75 per hour average is roughly \$2,625 in time value per season.

But here's the thing—and I want to be honest about this—not all of that time feels like lost productivity to me. Some of it I do in the evening or on days when weather's bad and I couldn't be out working anyway. So the actual "billable work I'm missing out on" is probably lower than \$2,625.

Realistically, maybe \$1,500 to \$2,000 of that is time I could have spent on billable work. The rest is just... administrative work that happens when it happens.

So yeah, there's value there, but it's not like I'm hemorrhaging money because of my current system. Does that make sense?

Interviewer: If you got audited tomorrow, how prepared would you be to show documentation? What would it take to feel fully prepared?

Dorian: Let me think about that honestly... I'd probably be... maybe 60 to 65 percent prepared? I could pull together documentation, and I think it would be fairly complete. But I wouldn't feel totally confident about it.

Here's what I could show an inspector: My spreadsheet with all my applications logged. Product names, rates, dates, fields. My notebook going back several years. Product labels and safety data sheets filed away. Notes on weather conditions—though those are inconsistent.

But here's what would make me nervous: The documentation isn't organized in an obviously audit-ready format. An inspector would have to dig through my spreadsheet and my notes to piece together a complete picture. And there are gaps in the data I've captured. Like, I don't have systematic documentation of wind speed or temperature for every single application. I've got some of it, but not all of it.

Also, I wouldn't have a clear trail showing that I actually verified compliance for each application. I can say, "I followed the label," but I don't have documented proof that I checked the requirements before spraying. That might raise questions.

What would it take to feel fully prepared?

First, I'd want everything organized in one place in a professional format. Not scattered across notebooks and a spreadsheet and filing cabinets.

Second, I'd want systematic documentation of all the relevant conditions for each application—weather data, time of day, location, everything. Not sporadic notes.

Third, I'd want clear evidence that I verified compliance. Like, a record showing I checked the EPA label requirements and confirmed conditions met those requirements before I applied. Something that demonstrates I did due diligence.

And fourth, I'd want audit-ready reports I could pull up that show all that information organized clearly, so an inspector could review it without me having to explain or reorganize anything.

If I had those things, I'd probably feel 85 to 90 percent confident going into an audit. Right now, there's enough uncertainty that I'd have some anxiety about it.

Interviewer: If there was a tool that cut your record-keeping time in half AND gave you peace of mind about compliance, what would

you pay for it annually? Would that be worth it to you?

**Dorian:* Let me think through the value proposition here...
If it cut my time in half, that's saving me roughly 17 to 18 hours per season. At my \$75 per hour rate, that's about \$1,275 to \$1,350 in recovered time value.
Plus the peace of mind piece—knowing that I have professional documentation, that I could confidently show an inspector everything is organized and verifiable, that I'm not carrying around this underlying anxiety about whether my records are "good enough"—that's actually valuable too.
So combined, I'd say the total value is somewhere in the \$1,500 to \$2,000 range per season.
That said, I'd be willing to pay somewhere in the \$400 to \$700 per year range for something that delivered on both fronts. That's roughly \$33 to \$58 per month.
Would I go higher than that? Maybe, but I'd need to be more convinced. At \$100 per month, that's \$1,200 per year, and I'm starting to question whether the value justifies it. At that point, I'd want to see proof that it actually works, testimonials from other people like me, maybe a longer trial period to test it during a real spray season before committing to a subscription.
So my sweet spot is probably \$35 to \$65 per month—\$420 to \$780 annually. At that price, the math makes sense to me without requiring extensive vetting.
Now, would I actually test something like that? Yeah, probably. If you had a pilot program or a reasonable trial period during an actual spray season so I could see if it fits my workflow and actually delivers what it promises, I'd be interested in trying it. That's what would actually convince me to commit—real-world testing, not just marketing claims.
But I'd want to make sure it was simple to use and didn't add complexity to my current process. That's the key barrier for me.

**Interviewer:* Is there anything else about managing compliance or documentation that I should know?

**Dorian:* Yeah, actually a few things.
First, I want to be clear that I'm not against technology or improvement. I just need to see a real benefit that justifies making a change. My current system works, and switching costs something—time to learn, disruption to my routine, uncertainty about whether the new thing will actually work better. So whatever I switch to would have to clearly be worth that friction.
Second, reliability and longevity matter to me. I've heard stories about agricultural software companies that go under or stop updating their products. If I'm going to invest time and effort into a new system, I need confidence that you'll actually be around long-term. What's your company's situation? Are you funded? What's your business model? Those things matter to me before I'd commit significant time to your platform.
Third, data security is a real concern. My records contain sensitive information about my operations and my clients' operations. I need to know that data is secure. Who has access to it? Where is it stored? How long do you keep it? What happens if your company goes under—do I get my data back? Those aren't trivial questions for me.
Fourth, I'd want to understand data ownership. Do I own my records, or do you? Can I export my data if I want to switch to something else later? I don't want to be locked into a vendor permanently. I want to know I have options.
And finally—and I'll be honest—I'm skeptical of marketing pitches and sales claims. A lot of software companies promise more than they deliver. What would actually matter to me is hearing from other people like me who've actually used your system for a full season or longer. Real testimonials from people running similar operations. That would carry way more weight than any pitch you could give me.
But yeah, those are the things I'd want to understand before seriously considering a switch. If you can address those concerns—especially the company viability and data ownership pieces—then I'm open to learning more.

**Interview End Time:* 2026-04-09 19:45:33 UTC", "is_real_interview": false}

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